PRACTICE EXAM 29 / EXAM SET 05

Domain 1: Foundational Knowledge and Basic Science

15 scored questions	4 answer choices per question	Answer key + explanations included

Instructions

Choose the single best answer (A, B, C, or D) for each question. Mark your responses before checking the answer key and detailed explanations at the end of this document. These practice questions are not official NHA examination items.

QUESTIONS

Q01 | Health Care Systems and Settings

> **SCENARIO** A patient receiving active cancer treatment is referred to an outpatient team for help with pain, treatment-related nausea, and family support. The oncology plan continues, and the patient worries that this additional referral means cancer treatment must stop.

Which explanation correctly describes the referred service?

A. Hospice enrollment is required before an outpatient team can address symptoms.
B. Palliative care can support symptom management and quality of life alongside active cancer treatment.
C. Rehabilitation replaces the oncology plan whenever treatment causes symptoms.
D. Symptom-focused care is limited to an inpatient admission after disease-directed treatment ends.

Q02 | Medical Terminology

What is the correct plural form of diagnosis?

A. Diagnosises.
B. Diagnosi.
C. Diagnosis.
D. Diagnoses.

Q03 | Basic Pharmacology

SCENARIO For an adult's office procedure, the provider orders lidocaine hydrochloride 45 mg for local infiltration by the provider. Available solution is 1% weight/volume, defined here as 1 g per 100 mL. Use 1 g = 1,000 mg. The trained medical assistant is authorized under applicable law and clinic policy to calculate and prepare the ordered volume for the provider.

What volume contains the ordered dose? Round to the nearest 0.1 mL, rounding a halfway value up.

A. 4.5 mL

B. 0.5 mL

C. 2.3 mL

D. 45 mL

Q04 | Basic Pharmacology

SCENARIO During medication reconciliation, a patient taking prescribed warfarin says they plan to start nonprescription ibuprofen for joint discomfort. The anticoagulation clinician has not reviewed the proposed medicine, and the patient reports no current bleeding symptoms.

Which concern should the assistant flag for clinician or pharmacist review?

A. Ibuprofen is expected to reverse warfarin's effect and protect against bleeding.

B. Separating the medicines by a few hours eliminates the need to review the combination.

C. An NSAID such as ibuprofen can increase bleeding risk when used with warfarin.

D. Nonprescription ibuprofen is unrelated to bleeding risk because it is not an anticoagulant.

Q05 | Nutrition

SCENARIO An older adult recovering from a minor wound has a clinician-provided nutrition plan that includes adequate protein. The patient proposes replacing the planned protein-containing foods with sweetened drinks while keeping the same total calories.

Which explanation best supports the protein component of the existing plan?

A. Equal calories from sweetened drinks provide the same tissue-building materials as the planned protein foods.

B. The main purpose of protein in this plan is to supply indigestible fiber for bowel function.

C. Protein supports tissue repair only when it comes from meat, eggs, or dairy foods.

D. Protein provides amino acids for making and repairing cells; meeting a calorie target alone does not ensure adequate protein.

Q06 | Medical Terminology

SCENARIO A report describes a small mass as superficial to the biceps muscle. The assistant is reading the location before passing the report to the provider; no diagnosis or treatment decision is requested.

What relationship does superficial describe?

A. Farther from the body surface than the biceps muscle.

B. Closer to the body's midline than the biceps muscle.

C. Closer to the body surface than the biceps muscle.

D. Closer to the arm's attachment to the trunk than the biceps muscle.

Q07 | Basic Pharmacology

Which pharmacokinetic process moves a medication from the systemic bloodstream into body tissues?

A. Distribution.

B. Metabolism.

C. Excretion.

D. Absorption.

Q08 | Health Care Systems and Settings

SCENARIO A pulmonary clinic requests an allied health professional with specialized expertise in pulmonary function testing, breathing therapies, and instruction in respiratory equipment. The assistant is identifying the discipline named by that expertise, rather than selecting treatment.

Which team member best matches the request?

A. An audiologist.

B. A registered dietitian.

C. An occupational therapist.

D. A respiratory therapist.

Q09 | Basic Pharmacology

SCENARIO An adult's current asthma plan lists fluticasone propionate inhalation aerosol twice daily for maintenance and lists a separate medicine for rapid symptom relief. During reconciliation, the patient says they use the fluticasone only when sudden wheezing starts. The patient currently has no acute symptoms.

Which interpretation of the medication-use history is accurate?

A. Routine use would be inappropriate because fluticasone should be reserved for sudden symptoms.

B. Maintenance treatment can be replaced with additional doses of any rescue inhaler without clinician review.

C. The patient is using a scheduled inhaled corticosteroid as though it were a rapid symptom-relief medicine.

D. A symptom-free day indicates that the prescribed maintenance schedule should be temporarily stopped.

Q10 | Psychology

SCENARIO A patient says repeated billing worries have been stressful. After identifying the specific problem, the patient contacts the clinic's financial office and works on a payment arrangement to make the expense more manageable.

Which coping approach is most clearly illustrated by addressing the source of the stress?

A. Avoidance of the financial concern.
B. Problem-focused coping.
C. Denial that the expense exists.
D. Projection of the concern onto another person.

Q11 | Medical Terminology

SCENARIO A verified order specifies 2 drops in the right ear. A draft instruction incorrectly uses OD. The clinic's terminology guide notes that OD refers to the right eye, that AD may denote the right ear, and that ear and eye directions must be written in full to avoid confusion.

Which rewritten direction matches the verified site and the clinic policy?

A. Instill 2 drops in the right eye.
B. Instill 2 drops in the right ear.
C. Instill 2 drops in both ears.
D. Instill 2 drops in each eye.

Q12 | Nutrition

SCENARIO A clinician's existing preconception plan specifies 400 mcg of folic acid daily. A patient brings a supplement whose one-tablet serving lists "Folate 667 mcg DFE (400 mcg folic acid)." The assistant is helping the patient read the label without changing the plan.

How much folic acid does one tablet supply toward the amount named in the plan?

A. 667 mcg.
B. 267 mcg.
C. 1,067 mcg.
D. 400 mcg.

Q13 | Health Care Systems and Settings

SCENARIO For a particular position, the clinic's verified credentialing checklist requires both national certification and a separate active state-issued credential. An applicant presents a current CCMA certification and a receipt showing that the required state application is pending. No state-issued credential or approval can yet be verified.

Which checklist status accurately distinguishes the two requirements?

A. Both requirements are verified because national certification replaces the separate state credential.
B. Neither requirement is verified because a pending state application invalidates the national certification.
C. The national certification is verified, while the separately required active state credential remains unverified.
D. Both requirements are verified because submission of the state application establishes active status.

Q14 | Psychology

SCENARIO An adult following a clinician-approved activity plan receives encouraging feedback after submitting each completed weekly activity record. Over the following weeks, the patient submits the records more consistently. The feedback is added after the desired behavior rather than removing an unpleasant condition.

Which learning principle best describes this example?

A. Punishment.
B. Extinction.
C. Negative reinforcement.
D. Positive reinforcement.

Q15 | Basic Pharmacology

SCENARIO Before an authorized oral medication dose is prepared, the assistant compares the patient's verified full name and date of birth with the order. The names match, but the date of birth on the order belongs to a different record. The drug, dose, route, and scheduled time otherwise match the worksheet. Clinic policy requires a full name and date-of-birth match before preparation.

Which medication-administration right is the central concern that must be resolved?

A. Right time.
B. Right patient.
C. Right dose.
D. Right route.

ANSWER KEY & EXPLANATIONS

Practice Exam 29 | Domain 1: Foundational Knowledge and Basic Science | 15 scored questions

01 B	02 D	03 A	04 C	05 D	06 C
07 A	08 D	09 C	10 B	11 B	12 D
13 C	14 D	15 B			

DETAILED EXPLANATIONS

Q01 | Correct answer: B

Palliative care can support symptom management and quality of life alongside active cancer treatment.

Palliative care addresses symptoms and other needs associated with serious illness and can be provided alongside active treatment. This outpatient referral does not by itself establish hospice enrollment or require the patient to stop the oncology plan.

Q02 | Correct answer: D

Diagnoses.

The plural of diagnosis is diagnoses. This medical term changes its ending from -sis to -ses rather than adding the usual English plural ending.

Q03 | Correct answer: A

4.5 mL

First convert the concentration: 1,000 mg / 100 mL = 10 mg/mL. The ordered volume is 45 mg / 10 mg/mL = 4.5 mL. Treating 1% as 1 mg/mL would incorrectly produce a tenfold volume.

Q04 | Correct answer: C

An NSAID such as ibuprofen can increase bleeding risk when used with warfarin.

NSAIDs, including ibuprofen, can increase bleeding risk when used with warfarin. Nonprescription availability and a different drug class do not make the combination harmless; the assistant should report the proposed use without independently changing warfarin or selecting a replacement analgesic.

Q05 | Correct answer: D

Protein provides amino acids for making and repairing cells; meeting a calorie target alone does not ensure adequate protein.

Dietary protein supplies amino acids used to make and repair body cells. Calories from sugar can supply energy but do not replace those protein needs, and both animal and suitable plant foods can contribute protein. The assistant should reinforce the existing plan rather than prescribe a new intake target.

Q06 | Correct answer: C

Closer to the body surface than the biceps muscle.

Superficial indicates a location nearer the body surface relative to the named reference structure. Deep indicates farther from the surface, while medial and proximal describe different directional relationships.

Q07 | Correct answer: A

Distribution.

Distribution is movement of a drug from blood into tissues and other body compartments. Absorption moves a drug into the circulation from its administration site; metabolism chemically changes it, and excretion removes drug or metabolites from the body.

Q08 | Correct answer: D

A respiratory therapist.

Respiratory therapists specialize in evaluation and support of breathing function, respiratory treatments, and related equipment. The other disciplines have different areas of expertise, even though they may work with some of the same patients.

Q09 | Correct answer: C

The patient is using a scheduled inhaled corticosteroid as though it were a rapid symptom-relief medicine.

Inhaled fluticasone is a maintenance corticosteroid, not a medicine for rapid relief of acute bronchospasm. The reported use differs from the supplied plan and should be documented and brought to the clinician for review and reinforcement of the existing instructions. The assistant should not independently replace maintenance therapy or create a new dosing schedule.

Q10 | Correct answer: B

Problem-focused coping.

Problem-focused coping uses practical action to address a stressor or change the situation causing stress. The patient acknowledges the expense and works on an arrangement, rather than avoiding the problem or denying it.

Q11 | Correct answer: B

Instill 2 drops in the right ear.

Writing right ear in full preserves the verified anatomical site and removes the misleading abbreviation. Expanding OD as right eye would carry forward the drafting error rather than matching the original order; changing to both ears would also alter the direction.

Q12 | Correct answer: D

400 mcg.

The parenthetical amount identifies 400 mcg of folic acid per tablet. The 667 mcg DFE value expresses folate in dietary folate equivalents; it is not an additional quantity to add to the folic acid amount. Label interpretation does not authorize the assistant to change the clinician's supplementation instructions.

Q13 | Correct answer: C

The national certification is verified, while the separately required active state credential remains unverified.

The checklist identifies two independent requirements: the current certification supports one, but a pending application does not establish an active government-issued credential. Certification and governmental authorization should be verified separately using the applicable sources; the question supplies this position's requirements rather than asserting a universal state rule.

Q14 | Correct answer: D

Positive reinforcement.

Positive reinforcement adds a desirable consequence after a behavior and is associated with that behavior becoming more frequent. Negative reinforcement increases behavior by removing an unpleasant condition, while punishment aims to decrease a behavior and extinction involves withholding reinforcement.

Q15 | Correct answer: B

Right patient.

The date-of-birth mismatch means that the order has not been reliably matched to the intended patient. A correct drug, dose, route, and time on the worksheet do not resolve that identity discrepancy; the assistant should stop preparation and obtain the required record and order clarification under clinic policy.

End of Practice Exam